

Soundtrack Changes Scene Student Handout

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • The Arts • 20-30 min

Category	The Arts	Time	20-30 min
Difficulty	Easy	ID	soundtrack-changes-scene

Big idea: Artistic elements can guide emotion and interpretation before explicit evidence is considered.

Student-Facing Prompt

Inspect Soundtrack Changes Scene Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Soundtrack Changes Scene Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Scene: a person walks quickly down an empty corridor and opens a door. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Soundtrack Changes Scene Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Soundtrack cards: playful pizzicato, tense low strings, nostalgic piano, triumphant brass. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Soundtrack Changes Scene Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: Soundtrack cards: playful pizzicato, tense low strings, nostalgic piano, triumphant brass. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Artistic elements can guide emotion and interpretation before explicit evidence is considered.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students
1	After inspecting Soundtrack Changes Scene Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?
2	Which exact detail from Soundtrack Changes Scene Stimulus A did you use as evidence?
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?
6	How does emotion shape interpretation in the arts?

Ready-to-Use Examples

- Scene: a person walks quickly down an empty corridor and opens a door.
- Soundtrack cards: playful pizzicato, tense low strings, nostalgic piano, triumphant brass.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to The Arts.

Activity Steps

- 1. Show the silent scene and ask students to infer mood and story.
- 2. Replay or describe the same scene with different soundtrack styles.
- 3. Students record how each soundtrack changes character, conflict, or expectation.
- 4. Groups identify which evidence came from the image and which came from sound.
- 5. Debrief emotion as a route to artistic knowledge.

Observation and Evidence Record

Use this grid to keep observation, inference, evidence, and confidence separate.

What I noticed	What I inferred	Evidence	Confidence

TOK Debrief

- Knowledge question: How does emotion shape interpretation in the arts?
- Can music make viewers know something that is not visually shown?
- Where is meaning located: in the work, the audience, or the combination?

Knowledge Questions

- How does emotion shape interpretation in the arts?
- Can sound change what an image means?
- What counts as evidence for an artistic interpretation?

Transfer Example

For example, run this activity with one silent scene paired with suspenseful, comic, and sad soundtracks. Have students commit to an initial claim, then reveal the change, hidden rule, alternative context, or comparison that makes the knowledge problem visible.

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...